

FORMING PAWS

Business Plan

A health-first community for responsible dog breeding

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theplugai.xyz · github.com/morrisstephon51/forming-paws

1. Executive Summary

Forming Paws is a nonprofit platform for documented, responsible dog breeding, launched in Chicago. Dog owners create verified profiles, upload veterinary health documentation, and connect with other accountable owners through mutual matching. Health verification is the gate: no dog enters matching until baseline health documents are reviewed.

The platform is live in production at theplugai.xyz with accounts, dog profiles, health document verification with admin review, geolocated browsing, mutual matching, and owner to owner chat. The first real member joined in August 2026. The platform was built and is operated on effectively zero capital using an automation heavy development model.

2. Mission

Mission. Make responsible, health documented dog breeding the norm by giving accountable owners a trusted place to find each other.

The problem. Breeding connections today happen in unmoderated classifieds and social media groups. There is no health verification, no accountability, and no protection against mill style operations. The dogs bear the cost.

3. The Platform

Live today at theplugai.xyz:

- Owner accounts with profiles, location, and account management.
- Dog profiles with health documentation upload.
- Health document review: every document passes plausibility checking and routes to manual admin review when questionable. Automated checks flag, humans judge.
- Geolocated browse of verified dogs.
- Mutual matching: both owners must opt in before any contact.
- In app chat, unlocked only after a mutual match, with neutral public meeting location prompts.
- Admin console: review queue, reported conversations, and contact inbox.

4. Trust and Safety Model

Trust and safety rules are non negotiable and enforced by the product itself:

Safeguard	How it works
Health gate	Vet wellness exam within 12 months plus core vaccinations before matching unlocks
Verification	Plausibility checks at intake; questionable documents go to manual review
Gold badge	Optional OFA hip and elbow plus DNA panel recognition, a premium hook, never a gate
Anti mill limits	One litter per dog per 12 months; breeding age gates; education acknowledgment
Community safety	Chat locked until mutual match; reporting tools; rescue and adoption cross promoted

5. Market

The launch market is Chicago and surrounding Cook County. The initial audience is responsible hobby breeders and family owners of intact, health tested dogs who currently rely on word of mouth. Outreach targets are already mapped: local veterinary clinics, breed specific community groups, and dog owner networks, with ready to send outreach scripts prepared.

Rescue organizations are treated as allies, not competitors. The platform cross promotes adoption and is explicitly designed to reduce the unplanned and undocumented litters that burden shelters.

6. Structure and Revenue

Forming Paws is on a 501(c)(3) nonprofit path with no separate for profit arm, open to fiscal sponsorship to accept donations before IRS approval. Revenue develops in phases:

Phase	Revenue stream	Status
First revenue	Verified badge fee, \$29 per dog	Decision locked; launches with verification volume

Phase	Revenue stream	Status
Phase 2	Donations via fiscal sponsor	Pending sponsor
Phase 3	Listing boosts, membership tiers	Planned
Phase 3	Vet referral partnerships, sponsored education	Planned; see accompanying RFP

7. Operations

Forming Paws runs on a deliberately lean model. The founder invests roughly 30 minutes per day on approvals and irreversible decisions; an AI agent system carries the bulk of development and operations. The stack is Next.js on Vercel with a Supabase backend, TLS secured, with automated deploys. Total infrastructure cost is effectively zero at current scale.

8. Roadmap

- Now — Grow verified membership from the first member cohort; execute Chicago vet and breed group outreach.
- Next — Complete the five remaining build slices on the committed roadmap; apply pending database migrations; launch the \$29 verified badge.
- Then — Secure fiscal sponsorship, open donations, and formalize vet partnerships through the RFP process.
- Later — Evaluate expansion beyond dogs; the data model is already extensible to other species without rework.

9. Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Two sided cold start	Geographic focus on one metro; direct outreach to mapped vet and breed networks
Verification fraud	Layered plausibility checks plus manual review; community reporting
Founder bandwidth	30 minute per day operating constraint enforced by agent automation

Risk	Mitigation
Regulatory and liability	Nonprofit structure, education first posture, no transaction handling at MVP